Unspool finance model

Profit by user count, 10k to 10M · usage tiers · October 2026 · assumptions, not forecasts

1. Tiers

Tier	Price	What you get
Free	$0	1 reel per document, then 1 every 30 min (max 5/day), generated only when opened
1-day trial	$0 then $3.99/week	Plus for 24 h (card required, max 30 reels, once per account)
Plus	$3.99/week (≈$17/mo)	40 reels/week, no watermark
Pro	$5.99/week (≈$26/mo)	125 reels/week, longer docs, priority
Ultra	$22.99/week (≈$100/mo)	750 reels/week, priority, early access
Top-up	$2.49 once	+20 reels, never expire

2. Assumptions (same at every size)

- **Mix:** 94% free, 4% Plus, 1.5% Pro, 0.5% Ultra (6% paying). 2% of users buy one top-up a month. Trial conversions are folded into the paid shares.
- **Usage:** 30% of free users active a month, ~3 reels each. Paid users use ~40% of quota (Plus 60, Pro 200, Ultra 600 reels).
- **AI cost:** $0.03 per reel (Claude Haiku script, OpenAI voice, ~5 FLUX images, render). Today's estimate is ~$0.035–0.04.
- **Stripe:** 2.9% + $0.30 per charge, charged weekly (≈4.33 charges/mo). Paid users generate 69 / 217 / 1,300 reels a month on Plus / Pro / Ultra. **Infra** (hosting, database, video storage, bandwidth, email): $0.03 per registered user per month, minimum $500.
- **Not included:** salaries, marketing, support, refunds, chargebacks, income tax, VAT/sales tax. Real profit is lower.

3. Profit by user count (base case)

Registered users	Paying	Revenue / mo	Stripe / mo	AI / mo	Infra / mo	Profit / mo	Profit / yr
10,000	600	$16,289	$1,312	$4,128	$500	**$10,348**	**$124,176**
25,000	1,500	$40,722	$3,281	$10,321	$750	**$26,370**	**$316,440**
50,000	3,000	$81,443	$6,562	$20,642	$1,500	**$52,740**	**$632,880**
100,000	6,000	$162,887	$13,124	$41,283	$3,000	**$105,480**	**$1,265,759**
250,000	15,000	$407,217	$32,809	$103,208	$7,500	**$263,700**	**$3,164,399**
500,000	30,000	$814,433	$65,619	$206,415	$15,000	**$527,400**	**$6,328,797**
1,000,000	60,000	$1,628,867	$131,237	$412,830	$30,000	**$1,054,800**	**$12,657,594**
2,500,000	150,000	$4,072,167	$328,093	$1,032,075	$75,000	**$2,636,999**	**$31,643,986**
5,000,000	300,000	$8,144,333	$656,186	$2,064,150	$150,000	**$5,273,998**	**$63,287,972**
10,000,000	600,000	$16,288,667	$1,312,371	$4,128,300	$300,000	**$10,547,995**	**$126,575,944**

4. Yearly profit range

Low = half as many people pay (3%), High = 1.5× (9%). Everything else base.

Registered users	Low	Base	High
10,000	$59,289	$124,176	$189,063
25,000	$154,223	$316,440	$478,656
50,000	$308,447	$632,880	$957,313
100,000	$616,893	$1,265,759	$1,914,626
250,000	$1,542,233	$3,164,399	$4,786,564
500,000	$3,084,466	$6,328,797	$9,573,128
1,000,000	$6,168,932	$12,657,594	$19,146,257
2,500,000	$15,422,330	$31,643,986	$47,865,642
5,000,000	$30,844,660	$63,287,972	$95,731,284
10,000,000	$61,689,320	$126,575,944	$191,462,568

5. Detail at 10M users

Tier	Price	Share	Users	Revenue / mo	Reels / mo
Free	$0	94.0%	9,400,000	$0	8,460,000
Plus	$3.99/wk	4.0%	400,000	$6,916,000	27,600,000
Pro	$5.99/wk	1.5%	150,000	$3,893,500	32,550,000
Ultra	$22.99/wk	0.5%	50,000	$4,981,167	65,000,000
Top-up	$2.49 once	2% buy 1/mo	200,000	$498,000	4,000,000

Totals at 10M: revenue $16,288,667/mo, 137,610,000 reels/mo, profit $10,547,995/mo ($126,575,944/yr).

6. Reading this

- Profit scales almost linearly because most costs are per reel. At small sizes the fixed $500 infra floor matters a little; staff and marketing (not shown) matter a lot.
- Free users are now cheap (1 reel up front, the rest only when opened), so growth no longer drains money.
- The biggest lever is the share of users who pay. Each extra 1% of users on Plus adds about $1,341,859 profit a month at 10M users ($13,419 at 100k).

Planning only. Replace every rate with real conversion, usage and cost data after launch.